James Sanders

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Education

Rice University, *Houston, TX* **Graduated December 2022**
B.A. in Mathematics*, cum laude* (GPA: 3.91/4.0), *Phi Beta Kappa, SAT: 1520/1600, ACT: 35/36*
Significant coursework in *Economics*, *Philosophy*, and *Computer Science*
Relevant Coursework: *Artificial Intelligence, Econometrics, Reasoning about Algorithms, Game Theory, Social and Political Philosophy, Real Analysis, Microeconomics, Macroeconomics*

Economic Theory and Global Priorities Workshop, *Oxford, UK* **August 2022**
- Studied economic theory relevant to AI takeoff speeds, AI & the labor force, and long-term growth.

Skills

- Python, Machine learning in Pytorch, AI evals, Claude Code, MCPs, Git, R, GIS, MATLAB
- Proficient in Spanish

Relevant Experience

Research Associate, *Center for a New American Security* **October 2025 - Present**
- Worked to inform national security policy around AI hardware. Authored reports and delivered regular briefings to policymakers on technical aspects of AI hardware, export controls, data center security and associated policy findings.

Associate Data Analyst, *Epoch AI* **July 2024 - October 2025**
- Published paper analyzing trends in AI supercomputers, after compiling the largest existing public dataset of such systems.
- Analyzed and published research on relevant technical trends in AI development such as model architectures, training compute, model evaluations, inference economics, and robotic capabilities.

Quant Trader, *Susquehanna International Group* **May 2022-Aug 2022 (intern) and Aug 2023-May 2024**
- Developed software to analyze geopolitical and economic signals; forecasted world events including elections and major policy changes.
- Provided real-time liquidity as a market maker in housing index equity options.

SERI Machine Alignment Theory Scholars Training Program Participant **June 2023-July 2023**
- Studied AI agent foundations and research methods under John Wentworth.
- Conducted ML experiments in Pytorch that were relevant to interpretability and research design.

NASA DEVELOP Tech Lead, *Space Science and Applications, Inc.* **January 2021-April 2021**
- Used NASA's Earth-observing satellites Landsat 8 and MODIS to analyze urban heat island effects.

Leadership Experience

Friends Meeting of Washington, *Finance and Stewardship Committee* **January 2025-Present**
- Oversaw million-dollar annual budget for operating the Friends Meeting of Washington

Eagle Scout

Publications

Pilz, K. F., Sanders, J., Rahman, R., & Heim, L. (2025). "Trends in AI supercomputers." ICML Workshop on Technical AI Governance 2025, oral presentation.